Australian Government
Australian Sports Commission

CPM Report

Life satisfaction: evidence that sport makes you happier!

The Australian Sports Commission's Community Perceptions Monitor (CPM)* indicates a strong link between participation in sport in roles such as player, coach, official, volunteer or administrator and higher levels of life satisfaction. Individuals involved in sport consistently report greater overall satisfaction, with fewer giving low ratings compared with those not engaged in sporting activities.

The latest findings also reveal that many behaviours and attitudes associated with sport have reached their highest levels since the CPM's inception in February 2020.

Behaviours and attitudes associated with sport

73% Agree sport can be a good way to **meet people and make friends**

(up from 70% in 2023-24)

68% Agree sport is a place people can feel a **sense of belonging**

(up from 65% in 2023-24)

3.29 Average number of days per week **physically active**

(up from 3.07 in 2023-24)



Read more about Australian's attitudes to sport in the 2024-25 CPM Annual Report.

Life satisfaction across demographic groups

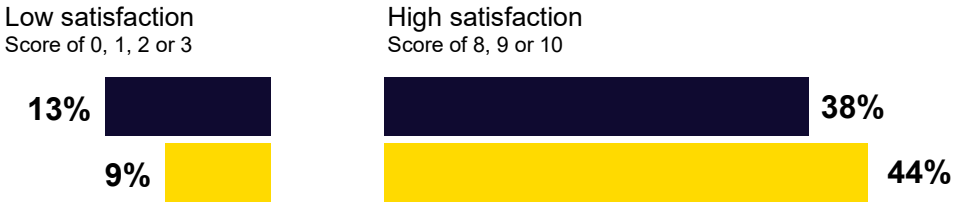
Life satisfaction trends are consistent across all demographic groups, with the exception of individuals who speak a language other than English at home (LOTE). The reasons for this difference are not yet clear and warrant further exploration.

On a scale of 0-10, how satisfied are you with your life as a whole at the moment?

Not involved in sport Involved in sport

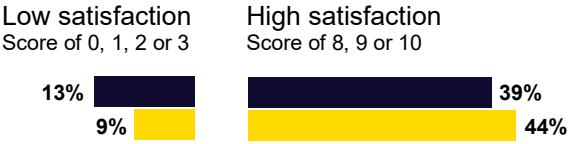
Based on data from December 2022 to September 2025 (n=17,604)

Total adults 18+ years

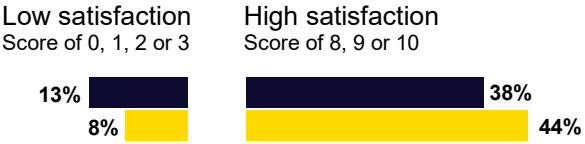


Gender

Men

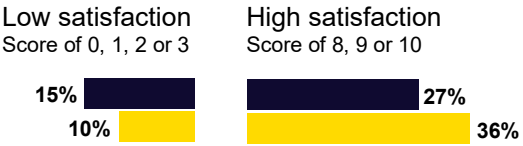


Women

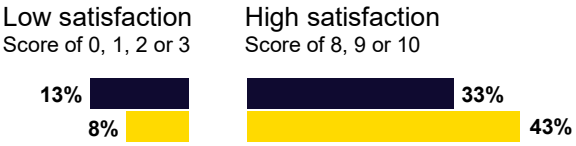


Age

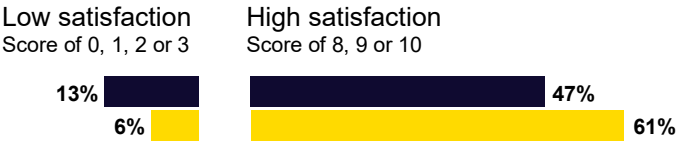
18-34 years



35-54 years



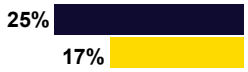
55+ years



Disability, First Nations & Language

Live with disability

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3

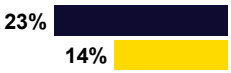


High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



First Nations

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3

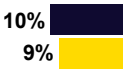


High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



Language other than english

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3



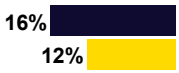
High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



Household income

Less than $90,000

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3

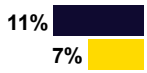


High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



$90,000 - $149,999

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3

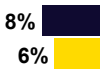


High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



$150,000 +

Low satisfaction
Score of 0, 1, 2 or 3



High satisfaction
Score of 8, 9 or 10



*The CPM is a monthly online survey of 500 Australian residents aged 18+ that measures attitudes to sport. It consists of a core set of questions run each month and ad hoc modules to respond to priority issues.

For further information, or to enquire about how to include questions, contact the Australian Sports Commission Insights team.